

Title: I've looked up a bunch of videos on CS and wave management but it's just not clicking for me.

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

I main top lane and usually use riven, just for normal draft picks as I want to practice before ranked.

Mid-late game is easy enough since I don't have to join every single fight and can farm and push in side lanes, the problem is early.

The guides normally mention stuff like 2nd, 3rd and 4th wave crashes, but not a lot else?

Half the time, whether I slow push a wave, unless I'm utterly dominating a lane, the other player just hard pushes it or slow pushes it and it goes back to neutral.

The guides seem to assume that your crash or slow push will go perfectly, but that almost never happens for me.

I slow push to build up the wave, delaying the last hit until the last second but it gets destroyed before it fully crashes anyway and I'm not usually dominant enough to fully punish them for taking a big save like that.

Or I fast push most waves after a kill but by the time turret plating is down, I've only done half the turret's hp.

I also try to back as soon as I've crashed a wave, which normally works unless they have tp but my problem is backing when I haven't crashed, half the time, it's after a fight or when I'm low hp so I either lost most of a wave or I have to leave as soon as a cannon wave comes up.

I can tell when a wave is pushing to me or them after looking for a few seconds but I struggle on what to do after that.

It's still just confusing for me.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 9]

This is a huge topic, and if you're new to the game, probably not worth worrying about.

In top lane, the initial waves set the tone for the rest of the game and so are very important. You need to have a plan for them.

What your plan is should depend on a number of factors, such as your matchup and whether you are strong side or weak side.

These days, imo three wave crash isn't great, you generally want to do two or four assuming you're in control of the lane. Whether you do two or four depends on your matchup and whether you think you will get ganked. If you think you're going to get 3 camped, that can happen at 2:30 or so. Full clear timer is 3:00-3:30 depending on how fast the enemy jg clears.

If you're not in control of the lane, ie you're playing the weaker laner, you want to deny their preferred plan, usually by denying the crash so it doesn't slow push back.

It seems like you don't understand why you would want one wave state or another. In general if you're stronger, you want the wave to push back into you so you can run the enemy down the long lane. If you're weaker, you would prefer the wave to get stuck outside of turret so you can farm safely. If you're weaker and the wave is slow pushing away from you, you want it to push as slowly as possible so the wave gets as large as possible, so the wave can protect you. In early levels, the damage you take from trading inside a large wave is substantial and can change the outcome of all ins.

If you're stronger and the wave is pushing away from you, you want it to do so as slowly as possible so you have maximum time to trade and so that when it does crash, you have enough time to take plates or proxy or both.

As you can see, slow pushing ends up being the desired state a lot of the time, hence why top often ends up being people taking turns slow pushing. Regarding people just blowing up your wave, you should just not let them do that. If you're stronger, you should heavy trade for that and if you're weaker, you just say "thank you sir", because they're inting and that's what you wanted anyways.

[Comment 2 | Score: 1]

Could you to your best ability, describe to me what your understanding of a slow push is? If we start off there i can certainly try to help

[Comment 3 | Score: 1]

Can you link op.gg?

[Comment 4 | Score: 0]

caring about the wave at all is already enough to get to silver-gold, and likely isn't your biggest weakness, just so you know. it's good that you care though.

just experiment with it - the theory of a slow push, what makes a slow push strong and how to do it is situational. in most lane states top, and sometimes bot, it is not a gotcha checkmate move, it's just the default option. it's situationally better than instantly shoving it into the tower because of any combination of the following: 1. you don't think you can clear the wave in time to crash it, and if you attempt to, the wave may get stuck in the danger/freeze zone outside enemy tower 2. building up a bigger wave means you get longer to recall or roam while the opponent is pinned under tower farming after you eventually crash. 3.the opponent is at a small disadvantage when trading when your wave is pushing (after 2nd wave reinforces) since your wave will be healthier and thus do more damage.

4. similar to point 1, slow pushing means you can spend more time near your tower, which leaves space to run the enemy down if you think you can beat them or flee easily if you're in trouble, then by the time you're close to the enemy tower you have a larger wave to protect you anyway.

ironically, the default move for your opponent in many scenarios is also to just let you slow push. walking up to the wave to nuke it often means walking into your danger zone, trading unfavourably, or exposing themselves to ganks. if they can't nuke your wave but do a little damage to it that kinda sucks for them because they give you the option to freeze. if your opponents keep just breaking your slow push that's fine for you - who cares, they would have been better off leaving it

you say all your slow pushes get destroyed without you punishing them because you think a slowpush is some kind of checkmate, which is only really true if you're strong enough to completely body them off a wave like if you got fed, or in a matchup like quinn vs garen, otherwise it's just the default that is slightly more favourable than fast pushing in most cases.